

A10112W1

FIRST PUBLIC EXAMINATION

**Preliminary Examination in English Language and Literature: Paper 3
Preliminary Examination in English and Modern Languages, Part 2: Paper 2(b)
Preliminary Examination in Modern History and English: Paper 4(b)**

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH (1830 – 1910)

TRINITY TERM 2018

Thursday, 14 June, 14:30,

Time allowed – 3 hours

Answer THREE questions:

You may apply the following questions and/or quotations to any author or authors, or to any work or group of works, as seems to you appropriate. You should NOT write more than one answer substantially on the same author.

Candidates are reminded that at the start of each essay they should identify clearly which question they are attempting, and, where appropriate, which option within that question, identifying it through a letter, where these are given (e.g. Q5(a)), and / or a key word or phrase.

Please do NOT turn over until told that you may do so.

1. 'No individual in the universe stands alone; he is a component part of a system of mutual dependencies' (SAMUEL SMILES).

Discuss any part of this statement in relation to the work of ONE OR MORE writers.

2. '[I]t is a narrow mind which cannot look at a subject from various points of view' (GEORGE ELIOT).

Discuss.

3. Oh! clasp we to our hearts, for deathless dower,
This close-companioned inarticulate hour
When twofold silence was the song of love.
(D. G. ROSSETTI)

Discuss the representation of love AND/OR the relationship between speech and silence in any literature of the period.

4. 'Blessed be those that grease the wheels of the old world, insomuch as to move on is better than to stand still' (ALFRED LORD TENNYSON).

Discuss the Victorian interest in time AND/OR progress.

5. "I – I'm a little girl," said Alice, rather doubtfully, as she remembered the number of changes she'd gone through, that day.
"A likely story indeed!" said the Pigeon, in a tone of the deepest contempt'
(LEWIS CARROLL).

Discuss Victorian attitudes towards childhood AND/OR education.

6. '[The grotesque] deals, to use the language of science, not with normal types but with abnormal specimens' (WALTER BAGEHOT).

Discuss EITHER the uses of science OR the relationship between the 'normal' and 'abnormal' in any literature of the period.

7. Tell all the Truth but tell it slant—
Success in Circuit lies
Too bright for our infirm Delight
The Truth's superb surprise.
(EMILY DICKINSON)

Discuss any aspect of this quotation.

8. 'Christ, like all fascinating personalities, had the power not merely of saying beautiful things himself, but of making other people say beautiful things to him' (OSCAR WILDE).

Discuss religious faith in the literature of the period.

9. 'The advent of female literature promises woman's view of life, woman's experience: in other words, a new element' (G. H. LEWES).

Discuss.

10. '[M]an may, if he pleases, invent a little world of his own, with its own laws; for there is that in him which delights in calling up new forms' (GEORGE MACDONALD).

Write on any aspect of this quotation.

11. Not all: the songs, the stirring air,
The life re-orient out of dust,
Cry thro' the sense to hearten trust
In that which made the world so fair.
(ALFRED LORD TENNYSON)

Discuss any part of this statement in relation to any literature of the period.

12. 'I don't like originals; I like translations [...] Isabel's written in foreign tongue. I can't make her out. She ought to marry an Armenian or a Portuguese' (a character speaking in HENRY JAMES'S *The Portrait of a Lady*).

Discuss Victorian exchanges with the foreign AND/OR attitudes towards travel in any literature of the period.

13. 'All the stanza is one long strain, though written in lines asunder' (GERARD MANLEY HOPKINS).

Assess the uses of form in the work of ONE OR MORE poet(s).

14. 'Melodrama is a way of coming to terms with modernity, or certainly provides ways of dealing with its complexities' (JIM DAVIS).

Discuss in relation to melodrama AND/OR any other literary form in the period.

TURN OVER

15. 'Could Nonsense be an attempt at re-organizing language, not according to the rules of prose or poetry in the first place but according to those of Play?' (ELIZABETH SEWELL).

Consider 'play' in the work of ONE OR MORE writers. (You need not discuss nonsense writing.)

16. 'Our tale is now done, and it only remains to us to collect the scattered threads of our little story, and to tie them into a seemly knot' (ANTHONY TROLLOPE).

Discuss narrative structure AND/OR endings in any Victorian writing.

17. 'Let the music speak to us of tonight, in a happier language than ours' (WILKIE COLLINS).

Consider the representation of ONE OR MORE other art forms in any literature of the period. (You need not discuss music.)

18. 'Do not relieve street-beggars, and avoid bye-ways and poor neighbourhoods after dark' (ROUTLEDGE'S POPULAR GUIDE TO LONDON, c. 1873).

Discuss urban experience AND/OR the importance of place in any literature of the period.

19. '[T]hey took nouns that were signs of things which gave evidence of wealth, – housekeepers, under-gardeners, extent of glass, valuable lace, diamonds, and all such things; and each one formed her speech so as to bring them all in, in the prettiest accidental manner possible' (ELIZABETH GASKELL).

Discuss any aspect of this quotation.

20. And you have failed, O Poet? Sad!
Yet failures are a commonplace.
Boast not as though you only had
Secured a failure in the race.
(MAY KENDALL)

Discuss EITHER optimism and pessimism OR the role of the writer in any literature of the period.

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